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PRODUCT DESIGNER

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Dear Prelim Team,

Where I grew up, in Roma, Texas, opening a bank account could take most of an afternoon. I spent a good part of my childhood translating forms and appointment calls for family who knew exactly what they needed, just not in the language the paperwork used. That's probably why account opening is the kind of problem I can't look away from.

From what I can see, Prelim's platform runs the same application in the branch and online, and this spring Stearns Bank chose it to unify those two channels. That's a specific design challenge I've worked on before. At Dell I interviewed small-business owners and redesigned a B2B checkout that had been written for a procurement department they didn't have: simpler wording, visible progress, fewer places to stall. A banker walking a customer through an account and a customer doing it alone on a phone need the same flow to make sense from both sides.

At H-E-B I led design for customer-facing and internal tools for three years. The biggest project was a guided AI assistant inside the Salesforce tools support reps use on live calls. I interviewed associates and managers, mapped how they actually decided on a refund, and designed the flow around that. Every participant completed their tasks in prototype testing. The common thread with account opening is that the person on the screen is under time pressure and the rules behind the form are complicated. The job is to keep the complexity on our side.

I'd be glad to walk through the Dell checkout or the H-E-B assistant, and I'm curious how your team tests the in-branch flow with bankers. Thanks for reading.

Best,
Marcos Rios